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‘The temporary Avadi bus terminus is unfriendly’

D. SURESH

The condition of the temporary MTC bus terminus in Avadi is unpalatable. The terminus is earthen and marked with pits, giving way for waterlogging during rains.

Navigating this area is challenging for passengers, particularly for those with mobility issues. Due to space constraint, buses are parked in a haphazard manner. Further, the number of seats is inadequate.

Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority is redeveloping the original bus terminus. I request the authority to complete the work and reopen the terminus without much delay.

D. Suresh is a resident of Thirumullaivoyal



‘Restore pond at GKM Colony’

C. S. VIKGNESH KUMAR

A pond called Vananan Kulam situated at GKM Colony at Periyar Nager near Perambur is in a state of neglect. It is located near K5 Peravallur Police Station.

The waterbody is overrun with vegetation and all kinds of waste are dumped here. It has turned into a breeding ground for mosquitoes. Further, encroachments have reduced the pond’s dimensions. The authorities should restore the waterbody and develop it as a recreational space with walkways around it.

C. S. Vikgnesh Kumar is a resident of Periyar Nagar



‘Waste set on fire at road in Nolambur’

BADRINATH . K

The service road abutting MCK Layout at Nolambur in Mogappair is becoming an illegal dumping site. All kinds of waste – plastic, food refuse, construction rubble, dried coconut fronds – are dumped along the road.

The air is also hugely polluted due to waste being set on fire. The burning often begins early in the morning, coinciding with school hours.

The open burning of municipal waste is prohibited under the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016, and violates multiple National Green Tribunal directives.

Users of the road will be inhaling airborne plastic. Stray cattle rummage through the uncleared heaps, scattering waste further across the carriageway.

Smoke emitted from a factory in



the vicinity adds to the problem. It appears to operate without any filtration measures. All these pose a serious health risk to residents. There

are around six schools in the vicinity.

Badrinath . K is a resident of Mogappair



The road near MCK Layout in Nolambur. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Thirunindravur commuters’ forum seeks better MTC bus services

It seeks direct bus services to Tambaram, Kilnabakkam, Anna Square and Red Hills

Thirunindravur Rail Passengers Welfare Association has made a representation to the Chief Minister seeking better Metropolitan Transport Corporation bus services connecting Thirunindravur and core areas of Chennai city.

The representation, dated July 30, 2026, seeks a bus service connecting Thirunindravur and Tambaram via Vandalur-Minjur Outer Ring Road and another route via Nemilicherry.



Likewise, another service connecting Thirunindravur and Kilnabakkam via Vandalur-Minjur Outer Ring Road and another route via Nemilicherry.

Other requests include: services to Anna Square via Anna Salai; to Red Hills via Avai and Ambattur; and a small bus service to Prakash Nagar via Gomathipuram, Sri Hridayaleeshar temple, Sri

Thirunindravur bus terminus on CTH Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Bhaktavathsala Perumal temple, Thirunindravur railway station, Lakshmiapuram, and Tata Steel Yard.

“MTC bus service is poor in Thirunindravur. Only service to Broadway via CTH Road and Kilpauk is provided. Commuters go to Avadi to board buses to go to other parts of the city. There are no train services connecting Thirunindravur and Tambaram. Buses are the only mode of public transport. So it is even more difficult. For the past 33 years, we have been requesting the elected representatives to improve the bus services. But our efforts were to no avail. We have made a representation now to the new government,” says S. Murugaiyan

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Electrocution risk lurks on key road, notes forum

Anna Nagar West Extension Association wants Greater Chennai Corporation to do away with the new stormwater drain as it has been constructed over electricity cables

L. KANTHIMATHI

With the North East monsoon just a few months away, Anna Nagar West Extension Association draws the attention of the Greater Chennai Corporation to the fatal risk of electrocution posed by a stormwater drain constructed in November 2025 on East Main Road at Anna Nagar West Extension. Highlighting this grave concern, the Association has made a representation to the Commissioner of the Greater Chennai Corporation last month.

“The new drain poses a threat because it is constructed right above a 33 kV high-tension underground electricity cable. When the con-

struction was under way, the Association saw this potent danger and took it to the notice of the electricity department. Then, those officials visited the construction site and were convinced of the serious threat and objected to the SWD work. However, GCC paid no heed and completed laying the drain. During the last North East monsoon, the drain was not ready but this year, provisions have been made for water to enter the drain. So, we want GCC to take corrective measures such as doing away with the new drain and prevent any untoward incident. This should not be delayed as the rainy season will set in, in a few months,” says J.M.S. Nagarjunan, the Association’s secretary. In the representa-

tion, the Association also notes the new stormwater drain was unwarranted.

“This new drain is the fourth one on this road. Citing the ineffectiveness and structural flaws of the other three existing SWDs, the new one was constructed almost in the middle of the road. Instead, GCC could have restored any one of them by correcting the flaws. Over the years, heavy duty motors pumps would be used to drain out the water. So, residents never felt the need for a new drain. The new drain constructed 18 inches above the road level has only reduced the road width resulting in slow traffic movement during peak hours,” adds Nagarjunan.



East Main Road at Anna Nagar West Extension.





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The clickety clack continues



LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A chorus of clickety-clacks from manual typewriters drowns the bustle on Jagannathapuram First Street, which sits in a tract of Chetpet where every house leans into the next somewhat like books in a library shelf. Inside, as young fingers dance over ageing manual typewriters, kept sprightly by consistent maintenance, teacher-plus-owner of Chetpet Typewriting Institute (est. 1975) P. Padmanabhan is supervising yet another class, spelling out instructions to students.

Typing proficiency opening doors to certain clerical positions in government and private settings, being an essential component in certain competitive government exams including TNPSC Group IV, certain categories of Staff Selection Commission, institutes of this nature still thrive. Padmanabhan points out every class includes students who see typing skill as an end in itself. Therefore, also expect those training for careers in law, the corporate world and so on to walk in through those doors.

And these multiple needs keep these instruments going, refur-



P. Padmanabhan at Chetpet Typewriting Institute; and (below) typewriter mechanic S. Thyagarajan.

2006, taking the mantle from his father and running Chetpet Typewriting Institute. The institute operating from a space in Padmanabhan's house, makes the overheads of running it manageable. He notes with quiet pride, "I am a certified high-speed typewriting expert and an official government examiner," recognised by the Ta-

mil Nadu Directorate of Technical Education (DoTE). With 50 students at present, Padmanabhan personally teaches both Tamil and English typewriting; shorthand classes are also offered. His voice resonating with justifiable pride, he says: "Search my name online, you will find it."

Certainly, decades ago, every street probably sported a typewriting institute. Those like Padmanabhan maintain their numbers would have dwindled, but their relevance has not been eroded. And this is why, 20 years after retirement, he continues to fill his house with a chorus of clickety-clacks.

'Rescuing' typewriters

The phone rings, and within minutes, 54-year-old S. Thyagarajan is on his way to 'rescue' another manual typewriter. There is no workshop, no colourful signboards announcing his trade. He is the workshop on the move; and his experience repairing manual

typewriters since 1986 is the signboard. Owners of typewriting institutes across Chennai have his number saved as "ICE". That is obviously hyperbole, but typewriter mechanics such as Thyagarajan are indeed indispensable in "emergency" situations involving these machines, as brands selling manual typewriters have long ceased production, and the old machines have to be kept in circulation. Thyagarajan entered the profession soon after completing Class 10, having been born into a family of typewriter mechanics, his grandfather and uncle particularly known in the trade. The clatter of these machines defines his earliest memories, and he is among a dedicated group of people who refuse to let manual typewriters become a memory. While typewriter manufacturers have ceased production, he says typewriters are far from extinction. "The spare parts still come from Delhi. A manufacturer who started the business when typewriters were in their heyday continues to supply them to this day," he explains.

He notes that around 40 regular customers, including several typewriting institutes still rely on his services. Thyagarajan once ran repair shops which he shut down as rents escalated. "Every occupation evolves with time. One phone is enough now to run your business," he says.

He is a staunch believer not only in these machines, but also what they bring to the table, well sheet. He is emphatic those trained on typewriters make fewer mistakes because their fingers develop greater typing accuracy than those who learn typing directly on computer keyboards, particularly while typing Indian languages such as Tamil. "Even my name has been misspelt umpteen number of times," he remarks bitterly, adding that such mistakes can create unnecessary complications in government records. And for that reason and also for the fact that livelihoods still depend on typewriting institutes, he wants these old machines to continue clicking away in classrooms and examination halls.

bished from time to time. Chetpet Typewriting Institute is not the oldest, but is symbolic of typewriting institutes continuing despite challenges from technology.

Padmanabhan belabours typewriting institutes' continuing relevance, citing numbers and benefits. "There are 4,200 government-approved typewriting institutes across Tamil Nadu," he states. "Typewriting equips a person to type faster and more efficiently. Once you master it, operating a computer becomes effortless."

This belief has had Padmanabhan, now aged 75, wearing a new hat post his retirement as medical photo officer (also known as 'medical photographer') from Rajiv Gandhi Government Hospital in

A plea to the Tamil Nadu government

Typewriting institutes are anxious over a government order dated October 28, 2024 stating that the Department of Technical Education (DoTE) in Tamil Nadu would be doing away with the practice of having typing exams on manual typewriters, shifting them to computers from February 2028. Echoing the collective sentiment of associations representing typewriting institutes across the state, J. Srinivasan of Karumari Technical Institute in Saidapet, told The Hindu Downtown that typewriting exams in English and Tamil should be conducted only on typewriters. He points out, "Besides, the Computer on Office Automation (COA) exam should not be merged with the English and Tamil typewriting exams. Instead, the current system of conducting the three exams separately with a separate certificate given for each should continue. Every year, more than one lakh students take typing exams, conducted every six months. Clubbing them with COA will reduce the number of takers; and that will result in reduced revenue for the government." Srinivasan adds that switching typing exams from manual typewriters to computers will affect the livelihoods of typewriting institutes and typewriter mechanics across Tamil Nadu, which he estimates around 5000 and 2000 respectively. He states: "Associations and federations representing these institutes and mechanics want this GO cancelled."

A Fight For Survival
In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at an old industry that is pitted against new technology

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers since Madras became Chennai, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer



ERR

In focus: Elevator Safety 101

If the lift in your apartment gets stuck often, it is time to check when its license was last renewed

LIFFY THOMAS

In the last one year, how many times have you or a family member got stranded in a lift in your residential building?

Of the 1,540 responses from Chennai residents that LocalCircles received to this question, 48% said they were fortunate not to get stuck; 25% were unfortunate to have that unsavoury experience once or twice.

Just like elevators in public spaces and mass transit facilities such as MRTS stations, those at apartment communities can show their malfunctioning machine side, frustrating residents. When an elevator malfunctions in any setting, private or public, and causes a safety threat to users, who are the entities one pins the blame on?

Going by a recent Supreme Court ruling, the manufacturer, the maintenance agency and the owner of the premises are jointly liable for any breach of the safety of lift users.

A pan-India study by community social media platform LocalCircles found 33% had no confidence in the safety of lifts installed in their building. Close to 32% of the respondents from Chennai said the lift in their community was maintained by the lift manufacturer via annual maintenance contract (AMC); another 37% said lifts were maintained by a third party via AMC; 20% said no regular maintenance, only repairs based on issues.

Although the Tamil Nadu Lift Rules Act, 1997 got amended this year, accountability is still raised only after a lift malfunctions or an accident happens. Ma-

ny lifts continue to function without license renewal.

Challenges to inspection

In fact, identifying lifts functioning without a valid licence is a big challenge faced by the Electrical Inspectorate, a department under the Government of Tamil Nadu. Besides other functions, the department is responsible for issuing of permission for lifts and escalators to be installed and for the renewal of licenses.

As per the Tamil Nadu Lifts and Escalators (Amendment) Act, 2025, which came into effect in February 2026, license for lifts has to be renewed once in five years.

V. Ramakrishnan, chief electrical inspector to the State Government, says they previously used to send reminders to buildings for renewal, but now that the process is "auto generated" they stopped.

Renewal process can be done online and must be initiated three months before it expires. The average fee for renewal and penalty for late payment is a small sum, a reason why many buildings ignore it. The renewal process is important to identify defects and take up preventive steps before a compliance report is submitted.

"It is not possible to keep inspecting buildings that have not renewed their licence as there are hundreds of buildings with this facility, but based on complaints we do random checks," says Ramakrishnan, adding that the public can bring it to the department's notice.

Recently, when passengers were trapped in a lift at Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station, the department sent out its team to inspect it.

Besides shortage in manpower, the Department is often faced with issues among residents in apartment associations who derail the

process for renewal.

The official says that very recently at an apartment in Chennai the secretary of the association had applied for renewal but the president called to complain that the exercise was taken up without approval of a majority of residents.

"In apartments, there is conflict among residents as those on the ground floor do not want to pay for lift charges and renewal, so we are asked to intervene," he says.

For complaints and other issues, email ceig@tn.gov.in and ceig@tn.nic.in



Paying a premium to ensure safe lifts

Casagrand Irene, a gated community in Manapakam with 295 flats spread across 15 blocks and 13 villas, has ensured lift-related complaints are kept to a minimum by paying a premium for the maintenance of lifts.

"We spend 4-5 percent of our total revenue in lift maintenance, which translates to around ₹ 10.5 lakh annually," says Lebbaeus Denis, secretary, Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association.

Under a contract with Schneider Electricals, the Association has signed up for Diamond Category Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC), which is the highest in the plan, gold and silver being the other two categories.

In the diamond category, all spare parts including battery come under unlimited warranty. Every year, the company also undertakes a pre-maintenance schedule in which they replace most of the parts in the functioning of the lift. Besides, what is mandated by the manufacturer, once in every two years the Association replaces the batteries as well, especially in blocks where lifts see more wear and tear.

As in many communities where owners of flats on the ground floor complain about paying for an amenity they rarely use, this community has faced this situation. With villas also dotting the community, they have a big voice against spiralling bills on lift maintenance.

Denis feels that expenditure will keep coming but Associations need to find alternative revenue streams. "We have allotted space for digital ads kept outside the lift that give us ₹ 6 lakh revenue a year, this way we are incurring a more manageable expense on lift maintenance and at the same time ensuring residents have little to complain about," says the secretary.

Exhibition at Lalit Kala Akademi till August 25

The main exhibition of Contemporary Now - Edition III is happening at Lalit Kala Akademi till August 25. The organisers invite the public to be a part of this event that has brought together leading galleries, artists, institutions and audiences across Chennai to strengthen India's contemporary art ecosystem.

The event continues with exhibitions and public programmes across Chennai, inviting audiences to experience contemporary art through multiple perspectives, spaces and conversations.

Programmes are happening at Ashvita's Campus, Alliance Française of Madras, Raw Mango, Apparaao Galleries and Gallery Veda.



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SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

When conversations around screen addiction come up, they almost always centre on children and teenagers. But what about the adults who spend their workdays peering into laptops, unwind by scrolling through social media, and end the day glued to the television screen?

Here is the outline of an answer to that. And it is being sketched by The Kraft Faktor, a small-batch handmade products brand, creating soaps, shampoos, perfumes, candles and home fragrances, that has over time tucked an experience-based initiative into the shopping bag, conducting craft-based workshops, curating personalised gifts and developing DIY kits for people to continue crafting at home.

Deepa Sam and Nabeela Rehman, founders of The Kraft Faktor (TKF), view digital overload as cutting across demographic divides. TKF has inked in a couple of small-batch workshops (Mindful Line Art & Pattern Making and Paper Alchemy - Beginner-friendly Decoupage) for August 15 (11 a.m. to 1 p.m.) at Playbae Cafe in Thoraipakkam that indirectly address screen addiction. For participation, the number of birthdays someone has had so far carries little weight. For additional details about the workshop, DM them on Insta @thekraftfaktor.

These workshops have a philosophical underpinning, simple but far-reaching.

"We are saying: consciously build a habit in your 20s and 30s of practising some form of art or craft every day," says Deepa. "It could be anything. It could simply be cooking a meal or consciously grooming yourself. If these small routines are done consciously, the results are not visible in one or two days, but over time they make a difference."

Participants of TKF's workshops range from young professionals looking for a break from busy work schedules to retirees trying to fill the void that often follows decades of routine. "We noticed that this stage of life often leaves a huge vacuum," says Deepa. "Many people naturally fall into digital consumption."

For the founders, the concern is not simply the amount of time

Screen addiction is disproportionately associated with children and teenagers, adults often being a glaring omission. In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft

Screen time off for seniors too



people spend online. It is the way screens constantly compete for attention. "For me, it is very simply put – overstimulation versus correct stimulation," Deepa says. "On a screen there are hundreds of images and notifications. Even if you are only watching a few posts or one reel, you generally do not stop because social media is designed to keep you hooked."

Here is the contrast TKF seeks to drive home through its workshops.

"When you are creating a craft with your hands, your brain focuses on one task for 15-20 minutes. You are following one process, one sequence, one goal. There is also a natural stopping point. You finish one page, one piece or one step," Deepa adds.

Unlike scrolling through an endless stream of content, craft requires people to interact with real materials, making decisions, changing tack and reviewing the output. Paper has to be folded. Wax has to be poured. Glue has to be applied. Hands move objects, feel textures and respond to the material in front of them. Instead of reacting to rapidly changing colours, movement and notifications, attention stays with one activity at a time.

Nabeela elaborates: "With doomscrolling, you are only taking in information. Every second you are absorbing something new. When you are doing an activity, you are constantly asking yourself, 'What next? How can I do this? Is there a better way than last time?' There's a give-and-take in the process."

Mindfulness is a healthy by-product. Someone who makes things regularly is also more likely to think carefully about what they buy, how they use materials and whether something can be repaired, reused or repurposed instead of discarded.

The workshops themselves are intentionally small, with no more than eight participants at a time. A DIY kit is part of what every workshop offers, making it easier for participants to keep practising long after the session ends.



From a line art workshop; and the result of a decoupage exercise.

Awareness events on importance of breastfeeding



During the event.

In observance of World Breastfeeding Week, Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education & Research organised events on the theme 'Breastfeeding for a Sustainable Start in Life: Strengthen What Works.'

According to a press release, the week-long events included community outreach initiatives

and academic sessions. Faculty, students, and healthcare professionals took part.

The programme was organised by the department of paediatrics, neonatology, obstetrics & gynaecology, paediatric nursing, community health, lactation research team, and clinical nutrition, adds the press release.

New entrance gateway at MCC school in Chetpet



At Madras Christian College Higher Secondary School in Chetpet. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A new entrance gateway has been constructed at Madras Christian College Higher Secondary School in Chetpet through the generous contributions of the alumni who studied at the school in 1975.

The gateway featuring an elegant clock tower and the

school's name plaque, was formally inaugurated on August 1, 2026.

The newly constructed gateway was dedicated by K. M. Mammen, chairman of the M.C.C. Association, in the presence of alumni, members of the school management, staff, and invited guests, says a press

release.

The new entrance gateway stands as a lasting symbol of the enduring bond between the school and its alumni, reflecting their gratitude and commitment to the continued growth and development of their alma mater, the release adds.

School observes Kargil Vijay Diwas



KRM Public School observed the Kargil Vijay Diwas. According to a press release, students presented papers on the strategic significance of the military operations and applications of classical physics and engineering in rifle designs, showcasing the integration of scientific principles with defence technology. The school paid floral tributes to soldiers in honour of their valour and sacrifice for the nation. NCC cadets presented a dance performance depicting Operation Sindoor, adds the press release.

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Pinkathon spotlights preventive healthcare for women in Chennai

The Zydus Pinkathon was held at the Island Grounds in Chennai on Sunday to promote women's health, fitness and preventive healthcare.

As per a press release, the event featured race categories ranging from 3 km, 5 km and 10 km to ultra-distance events of 50 km, 75 km and 100 km. Over 3,000 women were said to have participated in the event, including first-time runners, cancer survivors, visually impaired runners, babywearing mothers and senior citizens.

A hair donation drive was organised as part of the event, where several participants donated their hair to be used for making wigs for cancer patients. The event also highlighted breast cancer awareness through Zy-



dus Lifesciences' "The Easiest Exam" campaign, which encourages women to perform regular self-breast examinations for early detection.

Pinkathon founder Milind Soman

said the initiative aims to create an inclusive platform that encourages women from all walks of life to adopt healthier lifestyles and prioritise preventive healthcare.

RMKV's new collection inspired by Japanese culture

RMKV Silks, known for its wedding silks and silk saris, has launched a range of exclusive handwoven silks inspired by Japanese heritage and culture, 'Kumo Korvai', 'Mt Fuji', and 'Sashiko Reversible'.

The silks, known for their pioneering designs and advanced weaving techniques, have earned the brand two national awards, a Guinness World Record, and several patents, according to a release from the enterprise.

The store has partnered with the Central Silk Board to develop a modernised pneumatic

handloom, an innovation designed to reduce the physical strain of weaving while enabling artisans to better use their skills and enhance productivity. By making the weaving process less labour-intensive, the initiative has also encouraged greater participation of women in the craft, creating new opportunities while preserving the essence of traditional handloom weaving, the release added.

The store is renowned for its naturally dyed silk saris and patented 40 percent lighter 'Lino' silk saris, the grand reversible sari, and the world's longest theme-silk sari, the release said.

Bring your old zari sari to Rasi Silks

Rasi Silks (Radha Silk Emporium), which was established in 1900, offers a comprehensive shopping experience for the entire family. Its portal <https://rasisilks.com> displays a magnificent collection from signature Kancheepuram pure silk saris to lightweight cottons, Pochampally and Banaras weaves, said a release.

The portal also features a dedicated, premium segment of ethnic wear for men, designed for weddings, festivals and formal gatherings. The classic men's kurta is meticulously tailored from pure silk and fine cotton, featuring both subtle, minimalist designs and intricate traditional motifs.

The portal is secure for online payments, added the release.

The Mylapore-based outlet is having an old sari exchange initiative. Customers can bring in their heirloom, old pure zari saris for evaluation, and upgrade their wardrobes with stunning new drapes.

One year certificate course on entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai along with Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Ahmedabad is offering a one-year certificate course on Entrepreneurship & Innovation. Classes for this will start this month. Graduates aged between 21 and 40 years can apply. Applications can be downloaded from the following link: <https://editn.in/Web-One-Year-Registration>. For details, call 8668101638 / 8668107552.

E-Commerce workshop

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai is conducting a workshop on E-Commerce from August 19 to 21.

According to a press release, the session will focus on different types of direct-to-consumer business model; selection of appropriate e-commerce platforms based on business goals; creation of effective product listings and pricing strategies. Participants will also learn about marketing, customer acquisition, retention strategies, and branding.



Creation of YouTube channel

Another workshop on creation of YouTube channel will be held from August 12 to 14.

The programme will introduce participants to the effective use of artificial intelligence and digital tools for content creation, channel optimization, and monetization. The session will also focus on fundamentals of YouTube Analytics to understand channel performance.

Training in gold appraisal

The institute is also conducting another workshop on gold appraisal from August 17 to 21.

Participants will learn about the differences between karat and carat; methods of calculating gold and silver purity; and loan assessment procedures for gold and silver. All the three workshops will be held from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. at the centre's premises at EDII Road, SIDCO Industrial Estate, Guindy.

For details, call 8668100181 / 9360221280

DSAV shines at skating championship

Students of Dayasadan Agarwal Vidyalaya brought laurels to the school at the CBSE South Zone Skating Championship 2026-27 held in Andhra Pradesh. According to a press release, Preksha Solanki of Class IX won a gold medal in the Time Trial event and a bronze medal in the 500-metre rink event, while B. Deeptha of Class XI secured silver medals in the 500-metre and 1000-metre events. Tejaswi R. of Class X won a bronze medal in the 300-metre event.

Adding to the achievement, Preksha Solanki and B. Deeptha have been selected to represent the CBSE South Zone at the forthcoming CBSE National Skating Championship.



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